

MATH 301: Homework 1

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Question 1: From Blackboard

Proposition: Let S and T be two sets. If both S and T are countable, then $S \cup T$ is countable.

Note: If S and T are said to be infinite and countable; then they are said to be *denumerable*

Proof. Suppose S and T are countable, and there exists $A, B \subset \mathbb{N}$, by definition there exists a bijective function:

$$f : A \rightarrow S \text{ and } g : B \rightarrow T$$

To show $S \cup T$ is countable, we must construct a bijection $h : C \rightarrow S \cup T, C \subset \mathbb{N}$

Define $h : C \rightarrow S \cup T$:

$$h(n) = \begin{cases} f\left(\frac{n}{2}\right) & \text{if } n \text{ is even} \\ g\left(\frac{n+1}{2}\right) & \text{if } n \text{ is odd} \end{cases}$$

Note S, T must be disjoint; else $\exists n_1, n_2 \in C, n_1 \neq n_2 \ni h(n_1) = f(n_1) = h(n_2) = g(n_2)$

Thus, for the sake of the proof, presume S, T to be disjoint sets s.t. $S \cap T = \emptyset$

To prove the proposition we must show that h is *surjective* and *injective*.

0.1 Surjectivity

Proof. **Goal:** We want to show that $\forall y \in S \cup T, \exists n \in C \ni h(n) = y$

Case 1 ($y \in S$):

Let $y \in S$. Since f is surjective, $\exists k \in C$ s.t. $f(k) = y$.

Let $n = 2k$. By definition n is even. Observe:

$$h(n) = f\left(\frac{2k}{2}\right) = f(k) = y$$

Case 2 ($y \in T$):

Let $y \in T$. Since g is surjective, $\exists k \in C \ni g(k) = y$

Let $n = 2k - 1$. Then n is odd. Observe:

$$h(n) = g\left(\frac{(2k-1)+1}{2}\right) = g\left(\frac{2k}{2}\right) = g(k) = y$$

As every element $y \in S \cup T \ni n \in C \ni h(n) = y \implies h : C \rightarrow S \cup T$ is surjective. □

0.2 Injectivity

Proof. Goal: We want to show that for arbitrary elements $n_1, n_2 \in C$, $h(n_1) = h(n_2) \implies n_1 = n_2$. Suppose $h(n_1) = h(n_2) = y$.

Case 1 (Same Parity):

Suppose n_1, n_2 be both even. Then the following statements hold.

$$h(n_1) = h(n_2) \implies f\left(\frac{n_1}{2}\right) = f\left(\frac{n_2}{2}\right).$$

$$\text{Since } f \text{ is injective: } \frac{n_1}{2} = \frac{n_2}{2} \implies n_1 = n_2$$

Suppose n_1, n_2 be both odd. Then the following statements hold.

$$h(n_1) = h(n_2) \implies g\left(\frac{n_1+1}{2}\right) = g\left(\frac{n_2+1}{2}\right)$$

$$\text{Since } g \text{ is injective: } \frac{n_1+1}{2} = \frac{n_2+1}{2} \implies n_1 = n_2$$

Case 2 (Mixed Parity):

WLOG suppose n_1 is even and n_2 is odd.

$$h(n_1) \in \text{Img}(f) = S$$

$$h(n_2) \in \text{Img}(g) = T$$

$$\text{Since } S \cap T = \emptyset \implies h(n_1) \neq h(n_2) \equiv f(n_1) \neq g(n_2)$$

As $n_1, n_2 \in C$, $h(n_1) = h(n_2) \implies n_1 = n_2$. The function $h(n) : C \rightarrow S \cup T$ is injective □

0.3 Conclusion

Since h is both surjective and injective, it is bijective.

As there exists a bijective function $h : C \rightarrow S \cup T \implies S \cup T$ is countable.

□

Question 2: Sec 1.3 (q1)

Question: Prove that a nonempty set T_1 is finite iff there is a bijection from T_1 onto a finite set T_2 .

Question 3: Sec 1.3 (q4)

Question: Exhibit a bijection between $\mathbb{N}$ and the set of all odd integers greater than 13.

Question 4: Sec 1.3 (q6)

Question: Exhibit a bijection between $\mathbb{N}$ and a proper subset of itself.

Question 5: Sec 1.3 (q7)

Question: Prove that a set T_1 is denumerable iff there is a bijection from T_1 onto a denumerable set T_2

Question 6: Sec 1.3 (q8)

Question: Give an example of a countable collection of finite sets whose union is not finite.